

Empathy Map

Ideation Phase: User persona and pain/gain analysis

Empathy Map — FitBuddy

Target User: Fitness Enthusiast / Beginner

Empathy Map Canvas

WHO ARE WE EMPATHIZING WITH?

Riya, 24-year-old college student wanting to lose weight

THINKS & FEELS

HEARS

Frustrated that "You should try intermittent fasting" workouts don't work "Just go to the gym every day" Overwhelmed by too "Download this app" (too many features) many options "Hire a personal trainer" (expensive) Insecure about body "Drink more water, sleep more" Motivated to change Friends talking about their workout routines Worried about injury

SAYS & DOES

SEES

"I'll start Monday" Instagram fitness influencers Downloads fitness Complex workout charts in gyms apps and abandons Friends getting results while she struggles Follows random Expensive equipment she can't afford YouTube workouts Generic meal plans that don't fit her taste Complains about Lot of nutrition jargon she doesn't understand soreness and quits

PAINS

GAINS

No personalized plan A plan designed JUST for her Can't afford trainer Free AI-powered coaching Plans too rigid Flexibility to update plan anytime Poor nutrition guide Clear food guidance for her goal Loses motivation Motivational notes each day Confusing apps Simple beautiful interface No feedback loop AI that listens to her feedback

User Persona Details

Attribute	Details
Name	Riya Sharma
Age	24
Occupation	College Student
Tech Savvy	Medium (uses Instagram, YouTube, basic apps)
Fitness Level	Beginner
Primary Goal	Weight Loss
Preferred Intensity	Low to Medium
Budget	Limited (wants free tools)
Time Available	30-45 minutes per day
Motivation	Improved confidence and health

Key Insights from Empathy Mapping

Insight 1: Personalization is Everything

Users don't want generic plans. They need something that considers their **specific body, goals, and schedule**.

Insight 2: Adaptability Reduces Drop-Off

The #1 reason people quit fitness plans is **rigidity**. A system that adapts to feedback keeps users engaged.

Insight 3: Nutrition is Inseparable from Exercise

Users know they need to "eat healthy" but don't know **what specifically** to eat for their goal.

Insight 4: Simplicity Wins

Complex apps with 50 features are intimidating. Users want a **clean, focused experience**.

Insight 5: Motivation Needs to Be Built-In

Daily motivational notes and visual design play a crucial role in **sustained engagement**.

How FitBuddy Addresses These Insights

Insight	FitBuddy Solution
Needs personalization	Profile-based AI prompt generates unique plan
Plan is too rigid	Feedback tab to update plan with natural language
Confused about nutrition	Dedicated Nutrition Tips tab with Gemini AI
App is too complex	Single-page app with 3 clear tabs
Needs motivation	Motivational notes in each day card of the plan